Grading Rubric
Essay 1: The Personal Essay

CATEGORY	4	3	2	1
Introduction	First paragraph has a \"grabber\" or catchy beginning using vivid detail that introduces a problem/conflict.	First paragraph has a weak \"grabber\" using general detail that does not introduce a problem/conflict.	A catchy beginning was attempted but was confusing.	No attempt was made to catch the reader\'s attention in the first paragraph.
Problem/Conflict	It is very easy for the reader to understand the problem the main characters face and why it is a problem.	It is fairly easy for the reader to understand the problem the main characters face and why it is a problem.	It is fairly easy for the reader to understand the problem the main characters face but it is not clear why it is a problem.	It is not clear what problem the main characters face.
Action	Several action verbs (active voice) are used to describe what is happening in the story. The story seems exciting!	Several action verbs are used to describe what is happening in the story, but the word choice doesn\'t make the story as exciting as it could be.	A variety of verbs (passive voice) are used and describe the action accurately but not in a very exciting way.	Little variety seen in the verbs that are used. The story seems a little boring.
Solution/Resolution	The solution to the character\'s problem is easy to understand, and is logical. There are no loose ends.	The solution to the character\'s problem is easy to understand, and is somewhat logical.	The solution to the character\'s problem is a little hard to understand.	No solution is attempted or it is impossible to understand.
Organization	The story is very well organized. One idea or scene follows another in a logical sequence with clear transitions.	The story is pretty well organized. One idea or scene may seem out of place. Clear transitions are used.	The story is a little hard to follow. The transitions are sometimes not clear.	Ideas and scenes seem to be randomly arranged.
Spelling and Punctuation	There are no spelling or punctuation errors in the final draft. Character and place names that the author invented are spelled consistently throughout.	There is one spelling or punctuation error in the final draft.	There are 2-3 spelling and punctuation errors in the final draft.	The final draft has more than 3 spelling and punctuation errors.
Title	Title is creative, sparks interest and is related to the story and topic.	Title is related to the story and topic.	Title is present, but does not appear to be related to the story and topic.	No title.